

You see, the intentional act of showing your kids how you make adult decisions over the dinner table is going to have a massive impact on their decision-making process and how they think about money.

As I've mentioned before, the big advantage I had growing up was being able to observe my parents making good financial decisions. They didn't think I was listening to them talk about money . . . and for much of the time I probably wasn't. But over the years, I saw them sacrifice, save and ultimately achieve their financial goals. It was one of the most important lessons I learned, and it was essentially through osmosis—drip, drip, drip.

And there's a simple way to do the same thing for your kids.

Include them in your decision-making.

Listen, I'm not suggesting they get to choose which car you buy, or your family of five could end up in a little red Corvette. Nor am I saying you should have the 'we're going bankrupt and it's all your bloody fault' conversation in front of your kids.

What I *am* suggesting is having child-appropriate conversations about money in front of your kids, to model good behaviour.

So when it comes time to replace the family car, make it a family decision. Sit around the table and discuss the features you want, and how to get them at the lowest price. Talk about the rubbish marketing that's designed to play on your emotions.

That's one way to show them what to do.

Another way to be a role model is to not buy crap you don't need.

My parents had the same refrigerator for 40 years. It was one of the first appliances they saved up for when they got married. And because when I was growing up my parents were, like, 100 years old, they'd been married 100 years, and therefore old Westy the Westinghouse was also a centurion.

Sure, it made a weird noise, but then again so did Dad. It was kind of like the family pet . . . it'd hum along in the kitchen at night. Even better, once a year Mum would have to defrost the freezer, and we'd eat all these weird